taxation, legal, succession planning (trusts, Wills etc.), and lifestyle needs of wealthy families.

"The conversation for larger families eventually shifts from managing investments to managing the family balance sheet like an enterprise. This institutional approach is increasingly visible among the next generation of HNIs," says Akash Hariani, Joint Managing Director at Motilal Oswal Private Wealth.

Single-family offices manage only one family's wealth, typically ₹100 crore and above; their operating costs are ₹2.5-5 crore or more. Multi-family offices manage the wealth of several families. They charge a percentage of assets under management (0.25% to 1.5%) or a flat fee (from ₹1 lakh and going north of ₹1 crore annually).

"A multi-family office generally makes sense only for families worth upwards of ₹30 crore. At that stage, optimisation of tax structures, access to institutional grade alternative assets like unlisted/private equity deals, and seamless wealth transfer become critical concerns. Below that, a good wealth advisor, a lawyer and a CA give most of the benefit at a fraction of the cost," says Neha Singh, Founder & CEO, Womoneysta, a personal finance platform for women.

"Family offices bring a structured ownership and execution framework, along with curated co-investing opportunities that can be niche and rewarding," says Vijeeta Sharma, Co-founder, Nexedge Capital, a wealth management and multi-family office firm. Those who do not prefer family offices can consider other avenues.

Holistic Approach

Family offices are a one-stop solution for managing all financial, legal and tax needs of the super wealthy

With a host of investment options, including PMS, AIFs and SIFs, asset allocation becomes critical

Smart manoeuvring of stock and equity compensation needed to avoid wealth concentration and plan for taxes

Tools such as private trusts, wills and governance structures are important for succession planning

MULTIPLE AVENUES, INSTRUMENTS

The most critical aspect of wealth creation is asset allocation—spreading investments across equities, bonds, commodities, alternative assets and overseas avenues. This ensures optimal risk-adjusted returns. Asset allocation is even more important for women in business and CXO roles as there is scope for creating generational wealth. The avenues include portfolio management services (PMS), alternative investment funds (AIFs), specialised investment funds (SIFs) and private credit/real estate funds. The ticket size ranges from ₹10 lakh (for SIF) to ₹1 crore (private credit, real estate funds). The fee is more than 2%. There could be additional performance-based levies as well.

Apart from these, even regular mutual funds and bonds can be considered. Fund managers (many of them are HNIs) of mutual funds are required to invest in the schemes they manage. "As wealth scales, families need access to a wider opportunity set—private markets, alternatives, global equities, fixed income etc. PMS and AIFs can play a role within that framework while overseas investing can provide geographic and currency diversification. AIFs are the access route to private equity, venture and private credit, while PMS is the conviction engine, giving focused exposure to listed equities," suggests Akash.

Singh suggests a core-satellite allocation approach. "The core portfolio of 70–80% can be diversified mutual funds, high-quality bonds and gold, allocated against clear goals. This compounds quietly. The remaining 20-30% is the satellite portion and can include AIFs, PMS, private credit/equity and SIFs."

What are the issues women face while planning their finances? "Women in leadership rarely lack capability. They lack time. Portfolios get reviewed reactively, between board calls, so rebalancing and tax windows slip. Compounding that, most advice isn't product-agnostic — it's pitch-driven, not assessed for asset class fitment, risk-return trade-offs, concentration across portfolios, tax efficiency, and honest competitive comparison. What's missing is disciplined, holistic advisory, not another product," says Sharma.

Singh suggests a simple advisory structure. "A coordinated team comprising a wealth advisor, a chartered